

all-rounders. And, I think the all-rounders will always be around.

You have played under M. S. Dhoni, Virat Kohli (pic, below) and Stokes. Do you see similarities among them?

All of them are very clear about how they want to proceed — whether it's being spin-heavy, batting-heavy, or deciding the bowling combination. Take Virat, for example: he built a formidable attack with (Mohammed) Shami, (Jasprit) Bumrah, and (Mohammed) Siraj, supported by (Ravichandran) Ashwin and (Ravindra) Jadeja in Test cricket. He was a brilliant captain who could succeed in all conditions.

Dhoni, on the other hand, didn't always have the best fast bowlers but maximised the potential of his medium-pacers and spinners. He even managed to get the best out of average players, which is remarkable.

It's the same with Eoin Morgan and Stokes. They know exactly what they want, back their players, and stick to their vision, adapting as needed. In the process, they've grown as both players and captains.

What changes would you like in the World Test Championship format?

There could be potentially two tiers or two kinds of leagues where you have a top-two playing the final. And then there's a bit of a relegation and promotion kind of thing, maybe.

So it depends on who's playing, etc. I think that's probably the best way to do it. My top teams would be England, India, Australia, New Zealand and South Africa. And the rest will have a tier-two system. The other teams can then advance to the league if they do well.

Having moved on from the game, what's next for you?

I would love to go into coaching and work with international teams or franchises. I think that's the path I'll be taking.



Player identification: Head coach Brendon McCullum and Ben Stokes have together identified players capable of handling different types of bowling, according to Moeen Ali. GETTY IMAGES

